

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ The U.S. economy returned to growth in the second quarter—with GDP rising at a seasonally and inflation adjusted 3% annual rate—after contracting in the first quarter. **A1**

◆ The Fed held rates steady for a fifth consecutive meeting but heard rare dissents from two officials seeking an immediate cut. **A1**

◆ The S&P 500 and Dow slipped 0.1% and 0.4%, respectively, after the central bank stood pat on interest rates, while the Nasdaq rose 0.1%. **B10**

◆ U.S. copper futures plunged roughly 20% in late trading after Trump unveiled 50% tariffs on copper products, but not on the raw material itself. **B10**

◆ Meta Platforms posted 22% revenue growth for the second quarter, showing that its core advertising business remains strong. **A1**

◆ Microsoft's cloud-computing unit, buttressed by massive demand for artificial intelligence, led the company to another strong quarter. **B1**

◆ South Korea's LG Energy Solution secured a multibillion-dollar deal to supply Tesla with lithium iron phosphate batteries for three years. **B1**

◆ Ford paid more than \$800 million in tariffs in the past quarter, a hit that erased the automaker's net profit and cemented its first quarterly loss since 2023. **B1**

◆ Nissan recorded a fourth straight quarterly net loss as the carmaker took steps to turn around its business and reverse falling sales. **B2**

◆ Hermès's sales growth accelerated in the second quarter despite industrywide softness in demand for luxury goods. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ Two top Senate Republicans laid out a plan to allow allies to finance donations of U.S. weapons and military equipment to Kyiv, following through on a plan pushed by Trump to raise billions of dollars a year for the war in Ukraine. **A7**

◆ The Chinese military said it would hold an annual naval exercise and conduct a maritime joint patrol with Russian forces next month near Vladivostok. **A7**

◆ The gunman who killed four people in a Midtown Manhattan office building bought the AR-15-style rifle used in the attack from his boss at the Horseshoe Las Vegas casino. **A3**

◆ The White House escalated pressure on Brazil, raising tariffs on the country to 50%, and Trump said the U.S. and South Korea have struck a trade pact imposing tariffs of 15% on South Korean goods. **A5, B1**

◆ A federal appeals court in Washington will consider Trump's invocation of emergencies to justify his use of tariffs to address a range of commercial, political and diplomatic issues. **A5**

◆ JPMorgan Chase Chief Executive Jamie Dimon visited the White House twice in the past two months, a sign of detente after years of tension between the head of the biggest U.S. bank and the president. **A4**

◆ Brown University will pay \$50 million in a deal with the Trump administration that will restore the university's research funds and settle discrimination complaints. **A3**

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Economy Returns to Growth

GDP rose at a 3% rate in the second quarter, but signs of weakness emerge

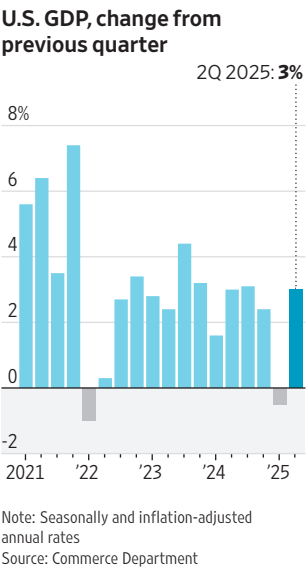
By HARRIET TORRY

The U.S. economy is growing again, largely because of trade swings and as American consumers keep spending. There are also signs of caution. The Commerce Department said U.S. gross domestic product—the value of all goods and services produced across the economy—rose at a seasonally and inflation adjusted 3% annual rate in the second quarter. That is up from a 0.5% contrac-

tion in the first quarter. Taken together, the two quarters show an economy that is growing, but more slowly. GDP grew at an average annual rate of 1.2% in the first six months this year, a step down from the 2.5% average pace in 2024. Both quarters this year were heavily influenced by swings in trade as businesses tried to navigate tariff threats and trade deals from the White House. “Businesses are very cautious—they don’t know the road map and so they’re driving in the right lane very slowly,” said U.S. Bank chief economist Beth Ann Bovino. Consumer spending, the

main engine of the U.S. economy, increased at a 1.4% pace in the second quarter, picking up from the first quarter as a steady labor market underpinned households’ spending power. But that growth was offset by weaker business spending on buildings and equipment. An important measure of economic health showed that combined demand from businesses and consumers softened. That measure, called final sales to private domestic purchasers, rose at a 1.2% rate in the second quarter, down

◆ Ford takes \$800 million tariff hit..... **B1**



Hometown Bids Adieu to ‘Prince of Darkness’



FAREWELL: Ozzy Osbourne's funeral in Birmingham, England, drew thousands of fans to mourn heavy metal's 'Prince of Darkness' along with his wife, Sharon Osbourne, and children. His U.S. reality TV series showed the rock legend as a family man. **A9**

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Which is the healthier soda sweetener? Both leave a bad taste with scientists. **A9**



SPORTS
She's 45 years old, but Venus Williams still can't quit playing tennis. **A12**

A Plan to Cull Canadian Ostriches Sparks an International Storm

Canada wants to euthanize 400 birds, pitting country against RFK Jr. and Dr. Oz

By VIPAL MONGA

Edgewood, British Columbia is normally a sleepy settlement of retirees. Lately, it's become the front line in a battle between the Canadian government and a coalition of animal rights activists, Christian evangelists and populists who have recruited U.S. health officials Robert F. Kennedy, Jr. and Mehmet Oz to their cause. It's all because of Universal Ostrich Farm, located on the edge of this remote 235-person community northeast of Vancouver. The Canadian government is trying to euthanize roughly 400 ostriches that are penned here, after 69 of the flightless birds died in December and January and two tested positive for a variant of

H5N1 avian flu virus. The owners of the flock and a group of activists are rallying to stop the cull. “It is government overreach at its worst, because we have rights as landowners,” said Katie Pasitney, whose mother, Karen Espersen, is co-owner of the farm. The animals have recovered from the outbreak and have developed herd immunity, she said. “These animals, we own them. The government doesn’t.” Under Canada’s policy for dealing with avian flu outbreaks, officials will kill any commercial flock whose members have been exposed. Canada’s food-inspection agency has said two of the ostriches tested positive for bird flu. It

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Soaring Meta Ad Revenue Fuels Push Into Artificial Intelligence

By MEGHAN BOBROWSKY

Meta Platforms posted 22% revenue growth in the second quarter, showing its core ad business remains strong at a time when the company is investing billions of dollars into artificial intelligence. For the first time this year, the company held its top capital-spending projections steady, a move that is sure to ease investor concerns over Chief Executive Mark Zuckerberg’s AI-spending spree. Shares rose more than 11% in after-hours trading. The results show the extent

to which Meta’s advertising business will continue to pay for the company’s outsized AI ambitions, as well as how the AI tools are contributing to its strength. Sales came in at \$47.5 billion, ahead of analyst expectations. Net income for the April-to-June period was \$18.3 billion, also ahead of market expectations. The technology giant said it expects to post between 17% and 24% revenue growth year over year for the current quarter. “The investments it’s making in AI are already paying

off in its ads business,” said Jasmine Enberg, principal analyst at research firm eMarketer. Meta is the third big technology company to report earnings this cycle, and shareholders are keeping a close watch on the extent to which revenue is increasing as a result of the AI boom relative to spending levels. Google parent Alphabet posted record sales last week and increased its capital-ex- Please turn to page A4

◆ Microsoft's cloud business drives its profit..... **B1**

AI Is Killing The Entry-Level Job

New tech dents the already fragile job market for college graduates

By LINDSAY ELLIS AND KATHERINE BINDLEY

What do you hire a 22-year-old college graduate for these days? For a growing number of bosses, the answer is not much—AI can do the work instead. At Chicago recruiting firm Hirewell, marketing agency clients have all but stopped requesting entry-level staff—young grads once in high demand but whose work is now a “home run” for AI, the firm’s chief growth officer said. Dating app Grindr is hiring more seasoned engineers, forgoing some junior coders straight out of school, and CEO George Arison said companies are “go-

ing to need less and less people at the bottom.” Bill Balderaz, CEO of Columbus-based consulting firm Futurety, said he decided not to hire a summer intern this year, opting to run social-media copy through ChatGPT instead. Balderaz has urged his own kids to focus on jobs that require people skills and can’t easily be automated. One is becoming a police officer. Having a good job “guaranteed” after college, he said, “I don’t think that’s an absolute truth today any more.” There’s long been an unwritten covenant between companies and new gradu- Please turn to page A8



THE FUTURE OF EVERYTHING
DUBAI CHOCOLATE RIDES INTERNET WAVE
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